



### Algorithmic ranking

Facebook's new update allows for users to bypass the algorithmic ranking of posts on your timeline. <http://dgit.in/apr21-73>



### Google Meet unlimited

Google Meet's unlimited calling service has been extended to June, and doesn't end this month. <http://dgit.in/apr21-74>

# Boo being online

## Time to jack out

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I'm just fed up. Sick and tired of all of this, and just want to go back to a simpler world. Back to the time when people could still think for themselves and there wasn't so much overload of useless information. You'd think a global pandemic would allow people to discover new things about the world around them, but no, all it meant was that we spent even more time online than ever before. And let's face it, on the internet, pointless cr\*p outnumbered the useful stuff 1000:1!

Just look at what we do online. We react. That's about it. The internet is a universe where people sit around all day allowing algorithms to show them useless stuff in the hope that we will all lift a finger to like, or heart, or +1 or whatever the heck the site of your choice uses to denote you giving your approval. If the content is extra special you might even be ar\$ed to move a finger twice in order to share the content to a different place yourself.

The people who earn the highest reactions, also earn the most amount of money, and then promote things that people don't really need to those reacting. In such a system you might think the best content would rise to the top. You might assert that what was most useful to people should get the most reactions, and thus, earn the most money and be the most successful... at this point we'd be forced to ask if you'd ever met humans before? What species is this that does what's best, and likes what's good and useful?

When was the last time you were on the highway, driving peacefully, marvelling at the good manners of all the other drivers who not just followed rules, but were courteous and mindful of other road uses? What planet is that, and how do we go there?

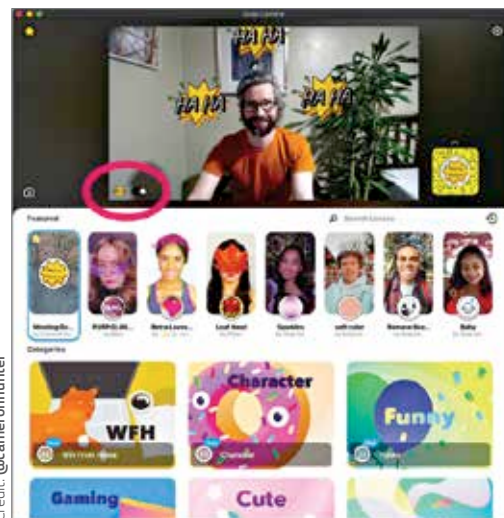
The internet is pretty much like the standard highway. Crowded, noisy, dirty, polluted, filled with people really bad at driving, but who also simultaneously think everyone else is bad at driving and curse them constantly. There's mini races going on between two or three cars along the way, while everyone else tries to

some sanity in their lives could just avoid those cesspools and try and enjoy the rest of the internet. Sure, the rest of the internet was still a fishmarket, but at least it wasn't filled with the blood and gore of social media. But not for long... you can always count on humans to find a way to destroy everything.

Because of the pandemic, video calls took off in a massive way, and virtual meetings / classrooms are just the norm now. These were places devoid of dopamine hits via reactions, until now.

As usual, developers ruin everything, and this time, it's a Netflix developer who came up with the idea of converting real-world gestures (well, on camera gestures), into animated emojis, and has ensured that the simple videoconference chat is going to be ruined forever.

Can you imagine eager to please humans all moving about like idiots on camera, all trying to trigger an emoji that no one should even care about in the first place? But, of course, they do care, because FOMO and groupthink is a real thing. People really, really want to be part of something



Credit: @cameronhunter

The Snap Filter for video calls that provides on screen reacts

avoid those racing idiots. Everyone is super sensitive, on edge, impatient, honking horns, and the only time everyone slows down and drives in an orderly fashion, it's because they're passing a nightmare of an accident that has blood and gore, and, of course, everyone stares!

And then we wonder why the internet is filled with utter cr@p?

All of this cr@p was limited to those ghastly things called social networks, and those looking for

bigger, and associate themselves with people and groups they look up to. And that's one more simple thing online ruined for good. What's next? Adobe Photoshop waiting for you to like the colour picker tool before it will work? People watching you fill out an excel sheet and hitting "Like" or "Share" when you enter a formula correctly? I should stop now, because I realised that I might just be giving people ideas for more stupid ways of make everything reactionary! 🚩